

CAN'T SLEEP

by

Swaraj Panda

swarajpanda331@gmail.com

We begin with a SONG: MOTION PICTURE SOUNDTRACK - RADIOHEAD
ESTABLISHING SHOT OF LIVING ROOM.

SHOT OF BEDROOM.

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

SWARAJ (18) sits in a chair by his window, soaked in blue light, staring out. (rocks his head restlessly)

(sigh) He reaches for his PHONE on the DESK.

He scrolls through videos, his face illuminated by the phone.

(sharp exhale) He puts the phone face down on the desk.

He pushes his chair back and moves out of frame.

We hear the SWITCH turn off (O.C). Song stops.

CUT TO BLACK

We hear the switch turn on (O.C).

CUT TO:

INT. DESK - NIGHT

A NEW SONG: begins.

A YELLOW LAMP illuminates a blank paper. Swaraj's hand enters frame and he begins doodling aimlessly.

CLOSE UP ON SWARAJ

He sketches with increasing frustration. Pressing harder until--

CLOSE UP ON PENCIL

SNAP!

The pencil tip breaks.

Swaraj SLAMS the pencil down, pushes back his chair and walks away.

We hear the SWITCH turn off (O.C). Song stops.

CUT TO BLACK

We hear the SWITCH turn on (O.C).

CUT TO:

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Swaraj sits at a keyboard. His fingers hover above the keys.

He begins playing attentively. We hear a pleasant melody.
The SOUND of his live playing is all we hear.

CLOSE UP ON LOWER FACE

His expression softens, a smile forms.

CLOSE UP ON FINGERS

We see keys being clicked

CLOSE UP ON EYES

His eyes slowly close immersing himself in the music.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

CLOSE UP ON EYES

Swaraj's eyes slowly open.

CUT TO:

He lies down on his bed.

We see him closing his eyes (color shift from night to day)

We see his phone alarm ring

CUT TO SWARAJ'S FACE

SWARAJ

Fuck.